

2015 年 9 月公共英语三级真题

SECTION I Listening

(25 minutes)

Directions:

This section is designed to test your ability to understand spoken English. You will hear a selection of recorded materials and you must answer the questions that accompany them. There are two parts in this section, Part A and Part B.

Remember, while you are doing the test, you should first put down your answers in your test booklet. At the end of the listening comprehension section, you will have 3 minutes to transfer your answers from your test booklet onto your ANSWER SHEET.

If you have any questions, you may raise your hand now as you will not be allowed to speak once the test has started.

Now look at Part A in your test booklet.

Part A

Directions:

You will hear 10 short dialogues. For each dialogue, there is one question and four possible answers. Choose the correct answer—A, B, C or D, and mark it in your test booklet. You will have 15 seconds to answer the question and you will hear each dialogue only once.

1. Where does the conversation most probably take place?

- [A] In a post office [B] In a hotel
[C] In a bank [D] In a supermarket

2. When will the bank open on Sundays?

- [A] From 8:30 a. m. to 8:30 p. m
[B] From 9:30 a. m. to 6:30 p. m
[C] From 8: 30 a. m. to 6: 30 p. mt
[D] From 9:30 a. m. to 3: 30 p. m

3. What did the man ask the woman to do?

- [A] Go on a diet [B] Have a snack
[C] Play some tennis [D] Stop screaming

4. Where are the two speakers?

- [A] In a hotel [B] At a dinner table [C] In the street [D] At the man's house

5.What can we assume from this conversation?

- [A] The man is a judge
- [B] It' s an interviewer
- [C] The man agrees with the woman
- [D] The man believes that Jack will quit his job

6.Why can't they meet on Thursday?

- [A] Because she wants to meet him on Wednesday.
- [B] Because she has to go out of town.
- [C] Because she is in charge of the project.
- [D] Because she has another meeting.

7.What does the woman mean?

- [A] The man should not expect her to go along.
- [B] She doesn't think she has enough money.
- [C] She will go even though the movie is bad.
- [D] The man should count the number of people going.

8.What does the woman mean?

- [A] She is asking for a higher pay.
- [B] She is introducing a new friend.
- [C] She is too busy.
- [D] She's got some problems.

9.Who is the man?

- [A] A judge.
- [B] An interviewer.
- [C]A professor.
- [D] A counselor

10.What are they talking about?

- [A] City is better than countryside.
- [B] Changes in the city.
- [C] Going camping.
- [D] Life in the summer.

Part B

Directions:

You will hear four dialogues or monologues. Before listening to each one, you will have 5 seconds to read each of the questions which accompany it. While listening, answer each question by choosing A, B, C or D. After listening, you will have 10 seconds to check your answer to each question. You will hear the recording only once.

Questions 11 -13 are based on the following dialogue.

11.How old is Katie?

- [A] 16 [B] 17
[C] 18 [D] 19

12.What kind of job is Katie looking for?

- [A] A part-time job for a school magazine
[B] A full-time job at a college
[C] A permanent job at Johnson's Imports
[D] A short-term job in an office

13.What qualifications does Katie have for the job?

- [A] Her extra classes in sport at school
[B] She has computer skills and used to working with people
[C] She's adaptable
[D] Her work experience in the school newspaper

Questions 14 -17 are based on the following dialogue.

14.How long have they not met each other?

- [A] Half a year [B] Two years
[C] Three or four years [D] More than five years

15.What's the purpose of Mr. Tim's visiting this time?

- [A] He wants to make some changes in his will
[B] He wants the woman's help in buying a land and building a house
[C] He wants the woman to see the architect for him
[D] He asks the woman to find a plot for him

16.When did Mr. Tim go to see the plot chosen by his son?

- [A] Last Friday [B] Last Saturday
[C] Two days ago [D] Yesterday

17.Which material should the house be built of?

- [A] Stone [B] Brick
[C] Cement [D] Wood

Questions 18 -21 are based on the following dialogue

18.Which city is the man going to visit?

- [A] Oxford [B] Paris
[C] Shaftsbury [D] London

19.Which tourist attraction is NOT mentioned in the dialogue?

- [A] Buckingham Palace [B] Shops and restaurants
[C] Tower of London [D] The British Museum

20.What is NOT listed on the man's schedule?

- [A] Shopping [B] Watching a show
[C] Meeting friends [D] Visiting art galleries

21.What can you infer from the dialogue?

- [A] The visitor will see very little of the city
[B] The visitor's schedule is tight
[C] The visitor will enjoy his time
[D] The visitor will leave for another city the next day

Questions 22 - 25 are based on the following TV interview program

22.Why are so many people dependent on cigarette?

- [A] Because they like the taste of tar
[B] Because smoking makes them feel relaxed
[C] Because smoking is funny
[D] Because smoking cures disease

23.Which substance in cigarette causes cancer?

- [A] Cigarette ashes [B] Nicotine
[C] Tar [D] Not mentioned here

24.What do experts suggest people to do?

- [A] To buy cigarettes with less tar
[B] To smoke only a few cigarettes a day
[C] To smoke only during a break
[D] To give up smoking

25.Why do smokers like low tar cigarettes?

- [A] Because they are less harmful.

- [B] Because they cost less.
- [C] Because they taste better.
- [D] Because they last longer.

*Now you have 3 minutes to transfer your answers from your test booklet to your ANSWER SHEET.
That is the end of Listening Comprehension.*

SECTION II Reading

(50 minutes)

Part A

Directions:

*Read the following two texts. Answer the questions on each text by choosing A, B, C or D.
Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.*

Text 1

Five-year-old Elia arrived at school with a big box of colored pencils. Her friend, Anna, offered to exchange her set of markers for the brand-new pencils. Elia agreed, but soon discovered that the markers were dried up. That's not fair!" cried Elia to *her* teacher. "I want my new pencils back. " After some tears and negotiation, the teacher helped the girls set things right by returning the items to their original owners.

Later that day, at story time, the teacher shared the picture book classic *A Bargain for Frances*. Though the conflict in the story is just over a broken tea set, the message about fair play was not lost on the children. The book was helpful in exploring a small, yet significant, life lesson.

Stories are vital to the way we process and experience life events and the feelings that surround us. The ability to create, share, and respond to stories is one of the vital characteristics of being human. In fact, the human brain is programmed to see patterns and become fascinated in the plot development of stories, finally storing them in long-term memory. As a result, the brain is a remarkably effective processor of stories, both real and fictional.

High-quality picture books are a good blend of art and literature that attracts kids' imagination and communicates an idea in an effective way. These books are perfect teaching tools, as they deal with the powerful emotions that kids feel, model effective coping strategies, and present complex concepts in appropriate ways. In addition, according to brain research, the picture book complements words with what leaves the most permanent impression: images. The

pictures in books are distinctive from the fleeting images kids see on television in that they remain on the page, ready to be revisited, touched, and commented upon.

Whether we share stories about families, historical events, or emotions, stories are a way to sum up life's memorable moments and lasting lessons. We can control the power of literature and use it to develop positive character in young kids by reading often, choosing suitable books, and enjoying stories together.

26. Elia cried "That's not fair!" as she thought that she was „

[A] cheated by her friend

[B] defeated by her friend

[C] ignored by her teacher

[D] scolded by her teacher

27. *A Bargain for Frances* is intended to teach kids how to _____.

[A] play fair in life

[B] organize things

[C] win in conflicts

[D] write a message

28. According to the text, stories can help kids _____.

[A] realize their potential

[B] improve their memory

[C] concentrate on reading

[D] understand the human world

29. In comparison with pictures in books, television images _____

[A] are frequently commented on

[B] stay temporarily with children

[C] blend art and literature vividly

[D] communicate ideas effectively

30. The power of literature can help kids develop their _____.

[A] positive character

[B] interest in history

[C] passion for stories

[D] learning strategies

Text2

We have heard a lot about the health benefits of tea, especially green tea. It is high in polyphenols, compounds with strong antioxidant activity that in test-tube and animal models show anticancer and heart-protective effects. Good clinical studies are few, however, and although physicians tell their patients to drink green tea, there hasn't been any definite proof of the value of that advice.

A team of Japanese researchers was able to link green tea consumption with decreased mortality from many causes—including heart disease. The researchers tracked 40,530 healthy

adults ages 40 to 79 in a region of northeastern Japan where most people drink green tea, following them for up to 11 years. Those who drank five or more cups of green tea a day had significantly lower mortality rates than those who drank less than one cup a day. There were also fewer deaths from cardiovascular disease.

But no such association was seen with deaths from cancer. Nor was consumption of oolong or black tea connected with any decrease in mortality. Those teas are easier to be combined with oxygen in processing, which not only darkens the color of the leaves and changes their flavor but also reduces their polyphenol content.

Coffee is more complicated. It has received both gold stars and black marks in medical literature. It, too, contains antioxidants, although they are less well studied than tea polyphenols. Evidence for the health benefits of coffee is growing, however. A group of investigators from Finland, Italy and the Netherlands reports that coffee seems to protect against age-related decline in mental capacity. The scientists studied 676 healthy men born from 1900 to 1920 and followed them for 10 years, using standardized measures of brain function. Their conclusion: the men who consumed coffee had significantly less decline in mental capacity than those who didn't. Three cups a day seemed to provide the most protection.

Population studies like those help us form assumptions about relationships between dietary habits and long-term health. We still have to test our suppositions in controlled conditions, and measure the effects of coffee and tea on various systems of the body.

31. Physicians often tell their patients to drink green tea because _____.

- [A] its medical value has been proved
- [B] it is believed to be good for one's health
- [C] it has long since been used clinically
- [D] its effectiveness has been shown in animals

32. The Japanese study seems to have confirmed the positive effect of green tea on ____.

- | | |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------|
| [A] young adults | [B] Asian people |
| [C] patients with cancer | [D] patients with heart disease |

33. The text indicates that black tea differs from green tea in that _____.

- [A] it can retain the color of its leaves
- [B] it can reduce cancer-related deaths
- [C] it contains less polyphenol content
- [D] it is stronger in flavor than the latter

34. Coffee is beneficial to one's health because_____

- [A] it has more antioxidants than green tea
- [B] it slows down the rate of brain aging
- [C] it lowers the rate of natural mortality
- [D] it keeps systems of the body active

35. The text indicates that the relationships between dietary habits and long-term health_____

- [A] are a falsely perceived supposition
- [B] are a conflicting issue among people
- [C] deserve further scientific research
- [D] deserve to be tested on a larger population

Part B

Directions:

Read the texts from a magazine section called "Letters" in which five people wrote about online shopping. For questions 36-40, match the name of each person to one of the statements (A-G) given below. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

Jennifer:

In your article about online shopping being the newest and easiest way to shop, you said that computers will replace shopping malls sooner or later because they make buying things faster and cheaper. But don't you think that the entire point of shopping is to spend leisure time with friends while doing something necessary. Shopping is not just a quick task. It is, in fact, an entire way of life.

Paul:

I am a great collector of all manner of hard-to-find items such as out-of-print books and antiques. Purchasing in physical stores would mean round-the-world travel and years of effort. I can get the same result in a few hours on eBay, and often at bargain prices. I am quite well-off, but buy very few consumer items available in regular shops. I have many friends and acquaintances with the same approach.

Mike:

My wife buys online often. I have not heard complaints or dissatisfaction. She can compare with different online vendors' prices after she has decided what she wants. It's delivered to the door, a big time savings and gas savings. If I need something, I check online first and see what

i costs and then decide where to buy, local stores or online. Online has the advantage most of the time.

Henry:

Virtually all online stores make you register. But, I don't need another username and password to remember. I will only buy online if I cannot find something locally. Even though shipping is fast, I'd rather drive across town and pay more to be able to bring home a new gadget the same day. And, most of the time, there is no difference in price between local stores and online stores.

Jeff:

If you think the prices are the same online as they are locally, you're dealing with the wrong online retailers. I'm an online shopping veteran and I always save quite a bit on my large-dollar purchases. With a little research experience, I've easily saved thousands of dollars over the last several years. Besides, shipping on most items is reasonable and you don't even pay taxes 99.9% of the time.

Now match the name of each person (36-40) to the appropriate statement.

Note: there are two extra statements.

Statements

- | | |
|--------------|--|
| 36. Jennifer | [A] I'll buy online only when I have to. |
| 37. Paul | [B] You can enjoy steep discounts with most online sellers. |
| 38. Mike | [C] I shift between buying on or off line depending on what suits me. |
| 39. Henry | [D] Shopping is not only a necessary task but a sociable pleasure. |
| 40. Jeff | [E] Online selling helps to satisfy my special needs in buying. |
| | [F] Buying online is far from being as good as it is boasted to be. |
| | [G] Buying online can save you a lot only if you find the right online sellers |

Part C

Directions:

Read the following text from which five sentences have been removed. Choose from the sentences A-G the most suitable one to fill each numbered gap in the text (41-45). There are two extra sentences that you do not need to use. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

"Any apples today?" Effie asked cheerfully at my window. I followed her to her truck and

bought a kilo. On credit, of course. 41 "Pay. me whenever you like," said Effie, climbing back into her truck.

All pretense of payment was dropped when our funds, food and fuel decreased to alarming lows. Effie came often, always bringing some gift: a jar of peaches or some firewood. There were other generosityies. Our baby was not doing well, so Effie financed my wife's trip to New York for consultation with a specialist.

42 Her income, derived from investments she had made while running an interior decorating shop, had never exceeded \$ 200 a month, which she supplemented by selling her apples. But she always managed to help someone poorer.

Years passed before I was able to return the money Effie had given me from time to time. She was ill now and had aged rapidly in the last year. "Here, darling, " I said, "is what I owe you." " Don't give it to me all at once," she said. " 43 " I think she believed there was magic in the slow discharge of a love debt.

The simple fact is that I never repaid the whole amount to Effie, for she died a few weeks later. 44 But a curious thing began to happen.

Whenever I saw a fellow human in financial trouble, I was moved to help him. I can't afford to do this always, but in the ten years since Effie's death, I have indirectly repaid my debt to her.

The oddest part of the whole affair is that people whom I help often help others later on. 45 So the account can never be marked closed, for Effie's love will go on in hearts that have never known her.

- [A] At that time, it seemed that my debt would forever go unsettled.
- [B] Give your help to those in greater need.
- [C] Effie was not a rich woman.
- [D] Effie worked diligently all her life.
- [E] Cash was the one thing in the world I lacked just then.
- [F] By now, the few dollars Effie gave me have been multiplied many times.
- [G] Give it back as I gave it to you—a little at a time.

Part D

Directions:

Read the following text from which 10 words have been removed. Choose from the words A-O the most suitable one to fill each numbered gap in the text (46-55). There are FIVE extra

words that you do not need to use. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

It can be a special experience to go on a family trip during the holiday season, but one reason that many parents 46 to stay home is the cost of travel. Here are some ways of reducing your travel 47 .

Flying is a fast way to arrive at your destination, but the cost of airline tickets can really add up if you are buying flights for the whole family. Often, it is cheaper to pay for gas 48 the whole family can fit in the car, 49 with the current decreases in gas prices.

If your destination is too far to drive to, you should look at a variety of 50 for your flight times. For example, it is often cheaper to fly on Christmas day instead of flying a few days before Christmas. Also, 51 early morning flights is cheaper than traveling during peak times during the day.

Eating out 52 you are on the road can quickly increase the trip cost, and it's much cheaper to stop at the grocery store, planning your own food 53 . If you plan to eat out, then it's usually cheaper to eat at a restaurant during breakfast or lunch, 54 you to skip the higher dinner prices.

Also, it might be cheaper to visit an all-inclusive resort. These resorts include all the meals and a variety of activities, and many of them have children's activities so that the kids can 55 entertained during the trip.

- | | | |
|--------------|--------------|----------------|
| [A] allowing | [B] if | [C] begin |
| [D] choose | [E] driving | [F] especially |
| [G] expenses | [H] instead | [I] before |
| [J] options | [K] stay | [L] taking |
| [M] too | [N] troubles | [O] while |

SECTION III Writing

(45 minutes)

Directions:

You should write your responses to both Part A and Part B of this section on your ANSWER SHEET.

Part A

56. Your friend Paul wants to know in detail about the part-time job you took at a restaurant during the summer vacation. Write an email to Paul, telling him about:

- 1) what you did on the job ;
- 2) how you felt about the working environment and co-workers;
- 3) what you learned from the job.

You should write about 100 words. Do not sign your own name at the end of your email. Use "Wang Lin" instead.

Part B

57.

Directions:

Read the text below. Write an essay in about 120 words, in which you should summarize the key points of the text and make comments on them. Try to use your own words.

Lori Schneider knows a few things about fear. "We were crossing a ridge that dropped off 8,000 feet on both sides," says the 53-year-old climber of ascending Mount Everest last spring. "The wind was blowing at 60 miles an hour. If there was ever a moment to panic, this was it."

But she didn't. An hour later, she reached the peak—the last step in her personal challenge to scale the highest mountains on all seven continents.

Ten years earlier, she'd come face-to-face with a different type of fear, when she was unable to feel anything in the right side of her body. After learning she had multiple sclerosis (MS) —a serious illness that gradually makes a person weak and unable to move or see, she left her marriage, job, and home: "I ran from my whole life."

It was just before climbing South America's Mount Aconcagua in 2000 that she set her sights on the Seven Summits. After training by pulling 50-pound bags of dog food up the ski slopes near her home, she topped Europe's Mount Elbrus in 2002, North America's McKinley in 2006, and Australia's Kosciuszko and Antarctica's Vinson Massif in 2008. She'd scaled Africa's Kilimanjaro in 1993. That left Asia's Everest, the highest of all.

And there she stood, on a ridge at 28,800 feet. "When I trained, I told myself to take one step at a time by spelling out words," she says. "So I spelled out, Don't let fear in., " It got her to the top.

She's the first person with MS to conquer the Seven Summits. With her condition stable, she plans a return to Kilimanjaro—this time with 15 others with MS by her side.